



SHAH JAHAN ▲

The fifth Mughal emperor, Shah Jahan came to power in 1628. Music, art, and architecture thrived under his rule, in a golden age for Mughal culture. In this painting, Shah Jahan sits in his durbar (court), with his son Aurangzeb saluting him on the left.

◀ MUGHAL TERRITORY

The Mughals expanded into neighboring independent kingdoms. The rulers of these lands were either defeated in battle, given a place in the Mughal government, or made to sign peace treaties (agreements). By the time of Babur's great-great-grandson, Aurangzeb, the empire stretched from present-day Afghanistan to southern India.



KEY

- Mughal Empire under Babur
- Mughal Empire under Aurangzeb

◀ FLORAL ART

Colorful designs showing flowers and animals were very popular in Mughal art, and were also used in architecture, textiles, and even jewelry. This 18th-century pendant, worn around the neck, is inlaid with gold, pearls, and precious stones.



1605–1627

Jahangir focuses on managing the empire. He permits the British to trade in India, which leads to the eventual fall of the Mughals.

1628–1658

Shah Jahan executes his brothers to win the throne. His reign is peaceful, and his passion for building leads to the creation of some of the empire's finest monuments.

1658–1707

During Aurangzeb's reign, the Mughal Empire expands to its greatest extent. However, it is plagued by rebellions, and begins to decline after Aurangzeb's death.

